

UPSC Civil Services (Main) Simulation GS-IV

QUESTION PAPER | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

INSTRUCTIONS

1. There are THIRTEEN questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. Questions 1-5 contain two 10-mark parts. Questions 6-7 carry 10 marks each.
3. Questions 8-12 are 20-mark case studies; Question 13 is a 30-mark case study.
4. Use ethical concepts, stakeholder analysis, options, reasons and safeguards.

Q1. (a) "One who is devoted to one's duty attains highest perfection in life." Analyse this statement with reference to sense of responsibility and personal fulfilment as a civil servant. (b) Distinguish aptitude, attitude and value as objects of civil-service assessment. Illustrate each with one administrative example.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q2. (a) "In doing a good thing, everything is permitted which is not prohibited expressly or by clear implication." Examine the statement with suitable examples in the context of a public servant discharging his/her duties. (b) Critically examine from the ethical point of view the proposition that Artificial Intelligence can serve as a dependable input for rational administrative decision-making.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q3. (a) Distinguish between "Code of ethics" and "Code of conduct" with suitable examples. (b) 'International aid' is an accepted form of helping 'resource-challenged' nations. Comment on 'ethics in contemporary international aid'. Support your answer with suitable examples.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q4. (a) "Judge your success by what you had to give up in order to get it." - Dalai Lama. What does this quotation mean to you? (b) An aspirational Code of Ethics is necessary but cannot be treated as a legally self-executing disciplinary code. Explain.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q5. (a) "We can never obtain peace in the outer world until and unless we obtain peace within ourselves." - Dalai Lama. What does this quotation mean to you? (b) Differentiate the roles of the CVC, CBI and Lokpal in India's anti-corruption architecture.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q6. Why is conduct that is legal not necessarily proper in public office? Illustrate.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q7. How does Kautilya's structural theory of official temptation remain relevant to designing modern anti-corruption controls in India?

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q8. Vinod, an honest IAS officer and Managing Director of a State Road Transport Corporation after six transfers in three years, receives documents and a video alleging bribery by the politically powerful Chairman. The opposition source offers future career support, while exposure may cause another transfer. Evaluate Vinod's options and the ethical issues arising from politicisation of bureaucracy. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q9. Raman, a newly posted State Director General of Police, confronts online recruitment of unemployed youth by a global terrorist group. State intelligence indicates targeting of a particular community and extremist social-media activity. Examine his options, measures to strengthen the existing setup and an action plan for better intelligence gathering. Address: (a) the

stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q10. A district administrator discovers MGNREGA records showing non-payment to genuine workers, defective muster rolls, mismatch between work and payment, fictitious persons, fund siphoning and works that never existed. How should proper functioning be restored and what action should follow? Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q11. A State proposes an AI system to select welfare beneficiaries and a water-intensive data centre to operate it in a drought-prone district. As district head, resolve the combined data, justice and environmental dilemma. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q12. A procurement officer receives a lawful-looking oral direction that would defeat the purpose of financial safeguards. Examine the ethical options and recommend a course of action. Address: (a) the stakeholders and competing duties; (b) the feasible options and their risks; and (c) the preferred course with safeguards and reasons.

[20 marks | 300 words]

Q13. You head a district welfare office that has introduced an automated system to rank applications for disability assistance. Complaints show that opaque data errors are excluding eligible citizens, while the vendor invokes trade secrecy and senior officials resist suspending a system praised for reducing pendency. A public disclosure could expose sensitive medical information, but continuing unchanged may deny urgent support. Identify the stakeholders and ethical conflicts, evaluate the available options, and recommend a lawful, transparent and time-bound course with safeguards and an appeal mechanism. Examine: (a) all material stakeholders; (b) the legal and ethical conflicts; (c) each realistic option and its consequences; and (d) the chosen course, implementation safeguards and review mechanism.

[30 marks | 350 words]

END OF PAPER